DISCUSSION BOARD FOR SLWCS TURTLE CONSERVATION PROJECT

Date	**Activity**	**Person (primary responsibility)**	**Comments**
Feb 13th	USF&W Proposal	Tom	The draft should be in place (at the bottom of this doc) by Feb 5th to allow time for editing.
Feb 1st	Raw data from turtle surveys	Samantha	

11th February 2009

Based on the data that Samantha has given the primary threats that are easily quantified are poaching and foraging by people and wild boars! Based on this information our project falls under the following IUCN categories (see table). The potential to change people's habits is greater than animals, are the boars native or introduced and are they hunted????

Samantha, thank you for the useful suggestions. Please could you tell me more about number 6, I believe that SLWCS aren't the first groups to suggest this...Sewalanka have been doing this at Pottuvil Lagoon? I think. Whether this was successful or not I'm not sure....

Behaviour Modification	Poaching prevention (on the beach)	Species Management
Behaviour Modification	General education / outreach / training / awareness and communication (to both managers and individuals [ie. the public]); illegal trade reduction through education	Education & Awareness
Behaviour Modification	Alternate livelihood training; ecotourism development; alternative gear projects	Livelihood, Economic & Other Incentives
Nesting Beach Protection	Moving eggs to hatcheries; beach monitoring	Species Management

Harvest Prevention	Preventing/mitigating bycatch; alternative gear projects; nest protection/beach monitoring projects; poaching prevention; derelict fishing gear impacts to sea turtles	Biological Resource Use

Material is slowly being added below to the

INTERNAL DISCUSSIONS
please put new textual info at the top here in chronological order -newsest first with a date so that it is easy to see what is happening. -Chandeep 1/28/09 11:19 PM

Please LOG OUT once you do your edits. -Chandeep 1/28/09 11:20 PM

January 28, 2009

Samantha - can you also post all the information you have on sea turtles for Kalpitiya extending north up to Mannar. We need to address issues on both coastlines if we are to address sea turtle conservation issues realistically.

Thanks,

Ravi

Dear all,

I am explainning here what SLWCS has done in the east coast till now and explain the petentials for a longterm conservation project for the conservation of turltes with comunity participation.
We conducted the preliminary site visits in the east coast in September 2008. Affter the basic site visites we started to interview the fishermen in three GNDs in Potuwil and Lahugala DS divisions. In Panama, Potuwil, Arugambe and Komari villages the surveys we conducted to discover the turtle nesting sites in the area and to ascertain the threats for the turtles. Accordding to the information gathered Komari, Arugambe, Panama and Okanda are the main nesting grounds of the sea turtles. No any systematic surveys has been conducted in the east cost to identify the turles coming to nest in the east coast. No any information previously publish regarding nesting beaches, nesting species in the east coast. This survey is the first and only survey ever carry out in the east coast especially for the turtles.
How ever first night survey conducted in the Arugambe in 09/09/2009 just before the nesting period. Beach petrols were conducted each hour from dusk to dawn.That survey ended with no sightings. But according to the fishermen and security forces that site was a known place to collect the turtle eggs for the turist hotels in the area.
In December 2008 started to get the permissions from the National security forces in the

east coast. From Trincomalee District to Ampara District the permissions received from the Security forces by informing them the project objectives. They are willing to support to the SLWCS research team since they beleive it is a vital need.

Again the second night survey conducted at the same place in Arugambe on 12/12/2008. Approximately 4Km long beach were petroled by two teams to search the nesting turtles at each hour from dusk to dawn. As same as the previous survey no records were found.
The next day 13/12/2008 another night survey was conducted further south to Arugambe and further North to the Panama. That site call Peanut farm and popular site for the turtle nesting. Each hour several beach petrols were conducted. Then two nestings were recorded that night. But the species couldn't identified because they already had left finishing the laying eggs. Both nests had poached by local inhabitants who sustain their economy through collecting the eggs and selling them to the local people. Only two eggs were left in a single nest diameter range from 3.6-3.8 cms. Based on egg sizes the turtle might be the Olive ridely turtle. Three old nests were found and those were poached by wild boars. Characteristically the poached nests by wild boars could identify by the convex shape dug pits and the surround area consists with shirinked egg shells which are soft. According to the poachers they have to compete with wild boars to collect the eggs from the nests. In that area shifting agriculture/ chena cultivation was done by local inhabitats in the encroached wildlife forest areas. These encroachers are the poachers who do the egg poaching in longterm.

Another night survey conducted on 18/01/2009 at the peanut farm beach site by the SLWCS field team with colaboration of Panama Nature Explores Society. On 18/01/2009 late night two new nests were found but both of them were poached by the chena farmers. From the North to the peanut farm three nests were recorded but all the nests had poached by the wild boars except those two new nests.

On 19/01/2009 early in the morning beach petrol at Peanut farm site 16 nests were recorded including new three nests and 13 nests made within one month. All three new nests and one old nest had poached by egg poachers while 12 nests destroyed by wild boars. Apprximately 75% of the turtle nests completely destroyed by the wild boars and some times they have killd the live turtle in the beach. 25 % of the turtle nests poached by the local inhabitatants who used to do the poaching.

On 20/01/2009 two sightings were recorded. Around 5 o clock early in the morning one Oliveridely turtle layed the eggs. The clutch size was 122 eggs. After counting the eggs redepositted in the nest and covered with a wire mesh which is enough to move to the hatcch out turtles. GPS location and put a pysical mark to ideentify the place. During the daytime around 1.30 pm a Green tutle was layed the eggs which was uncommon. The cluch size was 117 eggs. That eggs also redeposited in the nest and GPS location and the physical mark put in the place after covering the nest with a wire mesh for the protection againinst the Wildboars.

Mr. Gunasena who was running a hotel in the Peanut Farm very succesfully before Tsunami had a good economy. After Tsunami and the war the tourism was shrinked. According to him he has had earn some money through selling the turtle eggs which was just enough to survival aproximately Rs. 6000/= per month. Mr. Gunasena who earned the money collecting the turtle eggs has successffully changed his mind right now. SLWCS field staff explained the conservation value of the tutles for a better future of him. Now he is willing to provide peace of land legally from his land close to the beach to initiate a longterm turtle conservation programme. Now he is currently keep the records of turtle nesting, turtle deaths and poaching the eggs. Two nests that covered with the wire mesh are protected by him. To identify the accurate place of the nest of the turtles and to collect the eggs from the nest without any damage he has an excellent skill and practse. If we initiate any conservation program we can use him as a key person in the project and utilize his experiences for the conservation while supporting his economy.

In this proposal I have identifeid 2 main target groups.

1. CBOs- Fishermens (Fishemenses society), Young groups (Panama Nature Exploration Society and so on...), Illegal encroachers (Farmers) and Meththa samajaya (Lead by Civil security forces)
2. School childrens

Suggetions by Samantha

1. In this project we should target to identify key turtle conservation areas along the east coast.
2. We should propose to establish a conservation, research and training centre in the peanut farm.In situ conservation programme (Owner is willing to contribute part of his land)
3. Capacity building and training programes for the unemployers in the area.
4. Environmental education programes for the school childrensand to the school teachers.
5. Because the computer and English knowladge is very poor among the young comunity english and computer training centre is a vital part. If there is a possibility to have vocational training centre it is so valuable.
6. Establishment of a wetland plant nursery to utilize the local resources and fund raising
7. Organic composting centre and solid wast management centre. It will give employments and will help to run the programme even without funds.
8. Training for the sustainable agricultureand IPM.
9. Environmental education programmes and outreach conservation programmes for the farmers and the Fishermens inccluding all the stake holders.

Samantha Mirandu.

January 27, 2009

Hi Everyone,

My suggestions that we develop the proposal to conduct the project at two geographic regions. 1. The coastline from Kalpitiya all the way up to Mannar. 2. East coast in the areas that have been identified by the current field surveys. Sea turtle information for both of these regions are scarce therefore it is important to survey both regions. Additionally considering the security issues, if one region becomes inaccessible for any number of reasons we can always continue to work in the other region.

Since Samantha has given us summary of what has been done in the east coast and some suggestions based as result of it, now we need to put together a proper proposal. So please start writing it up per the format that is given below.

Best,

Ravi

Jan 26/2009
Hi everyone
for the purpose of this proposal is the focus still nationwide or have you refocused on the eastern province...? Coast of the Eastern Province as it is "unexplored" and offers the best potential for conservation. Especially the northern end, southern end and the area just south of Trinco bay. -Chandeep 1/26/09 7:16 AM
As for the target groups. could you let me know who you are directing this at... CBO's, women's groups, fishing cooperatives, community etc. all -as this is a MASTER proposal the tartget should be anyone who affects turtles and marine mammals in any way, where helping turtles means helping these people.-Chandeep 1/26/09 7:17 AM

Tom

Dear Tom,

Thanks for working on the turtle project proposal.

Samantha has some very interesting findings from the current field visit. We have found an excellent location for a base just south of Arugam Bay and are working with a local environmental group to collect data. The team have been recording nesting the last few days. The core activities of the project to USF&W and National Geographic should be

1. Establishment of a permanent research base at Peanut Farm area (Lahugala DSD, Ampara District)
2. Training and support of local conservationists
3. Education and capacity building -including set up of an english/computer training facilityThis component should be imbedded within the goals and objectives of turtle conservation and not stand alone as it does now. This is why so far almost all the funding orgaizations have stayed shy of it. The English & computer training should directly support turtle conservation (or whatever environmental issue we are attempting to address) - it is very important to make this connection -Ravi Corea 1/21/09 10:35 AM
4. In-Situ conservation program -using nest protection mechanism (not hard concrete which is impossible to move from nest to nest but a light material which can be easily put up, isn't easy for dogs/monitor lizards to burrow under etc)
5. Community management for sustainability
6. Eco-Tourism to build up conservation fund (but even with no tourists the project should be able to run).
7. Survey along entire East Coast along the Eastern Province.

Samantha will send you the raw data and pictures etc that his collected.

As mentioned before

1. We were invited by NGS to send in the proposal but no one has worked on this yet.

2. We need to apply for the USF&W Turtle grant - Feb 13th deadline

@ http://www.nfwf.org/AM/Template.cfm?Section=Browse_All_Programs&Template=/TaggedPage/TaggedPageDisplay.cfm&TPLID=30&ContentID=11331

3. SOSF proposal - https://docs.google.com/Doc?id=dgtwm95j_33dftghxg9&hl=en

For these we need to have a good proposal in order first and then we can put it in the formats required by each organization

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PROJECT PROPOSAL

Project Title: Turtle conservation in Sri Lanka – Coastal Conservation by helping people..

Name of the Implementing Agency: Sri Lanka Wildlife Conservation Society

Geographical Coverage: Sri Lanka, Coastal zone management, National census of turtle activity leading to focused efforts on the North-western and South-eastern coasts. Areas of intensified efforts

- Kalpitiya-Karaitive-Puttalam coastal zone – Northwest
- Ampara district – Southeast

Target Beneficiaries (including number):

Communities directly and indirectly impacted by the activities of the project; including but not limited to Community based organizations, Fisheries Co-operatives, Poachers, Women's groups, Local schools and Universities as well as etc.

Specific stakeholders by focus area:
Ampara District

1. CBOs- Fishermens (Fishemenses society), Young groups (Panama Nature Exploration Society and so on...), Illegal encroachers (Farmers) and Meththa samajaya (Lead by Civil security forces)
2. School children (Name of School, University)

Kalpitiya-Karaitive-Puttalam coastal zone

1. Please identify stakeholders on this region?????

Duration of project: 01/07/2009 - 01/07/2010 ??

Reporting period: ??

Total budget (in USD): ??

PROJECT SUMMARY *(Please include brief summary of project objective, activities and outcomes)*

1. Background and Justification for the project

Turtles are an important component of the biodiversity of the marine ecosystem. They serve as a keystone species by contributing to the health and maintenance of coral reefs, sea grass, estuaries and sandy beaches (Eckert et al. 1999; Turtle Conservation, Fund 2002). Furthermore, as some turtle populations of marine turtles travel hundreds or even thousands of kilometers between feeding areas and nesting areas, they involve in nutrient cycling by transporting large quantities of nutrients from nutrient rich feeding grounds to nutrient poor coastal and inshore habitats where they lay eggs. (IUCN/SSC 1995). Marine turtles are also considered as "flagship" species locally and internationally. By conserving these species and their habitats vast areas of marine environments and animals can be covered for conservation and management. Marine turtles also serve as "indicators "of the health of coastal marine environment accounting for their long distance migration and long life (Frazier 1999). Seven species of marine turtles belong to two families, Cheloniidae and Demochelyidae. These seven species include the Loggerhead (*Caretta caretta)*, Green (*Chelonia mydas*), Hawksbill (*Eretmochelys imbricata*), Kemp's ridley (*Lepidochelys kempii*), Olive ridley (*Lepidochelys olivacea)*, Fatback (*Natator depressus*), and Leatherback (*Dermochelys coriacea*) turtles (Meylan and Meylan 1999). The streamlined body shape and large flippers of air–breathing sea turtles mark the key features of adaptability to the marine environment. Marine turtles inhabit tropical and sub-tropical waters of the world. Although they spend most of their lives in ocean waters, adult females return to sandy beaches to lay eggs. Marine turtles migrate long distances during their lifetimes between foraging grounds and nesting grounds. Most sea turtle populations are diminished as a result of unsustainable harvest for meat, shell, oil, skin and eggs. Tens of thousands of marine turtles die every year due to entanglement in active and abandoned fishing gears. Furthermore, important nesting beaches and feeding areas of sea turtles are threatened and damaged by oil spills, chemical waste, persistent plastic and other debris, high density coastal development and an increase in ocean-based tourism (Eckert et al 1999). All seven species of marine turtles are included in IUCN Red List of Threatened Animals (Baillie and Groombridge, 1996). The Kemp's ridley and the Hawksbill are considered Critically Endangered; Loggerhead, Green turtle, Olive ridley, and Leatherback are listed as Endangered; and Flatback is considered Vulnerable. These categories present the global status of taxa and probability of extinction in the wild (Meylan and Meylan 1999).

The need to conserve the marine turtles in Sri Lanka

Lying at the southern periphery of the Indian Subcontinent, Sri Lanka offers a very important staging site for sea turtles that roam between the eastern coast of Africa and the Pacific Ocean. Out of the seven sea turtles of the world, five turtle species, namely, Green Turtle (*Chelonia mydas*), Olive Rridley (*Lepidochelys olivacea*), Leatherback (*Dermochelys coriacea*), Hawksbill (*Eretmochelys imbricata*) and the Loggerhead (*Caretta caretta*) seek refuge in Sri Lankan coastal waters for foraging and nesting (Deraniyagala 1953). Coastal communities of the Indian ocean, poach marine turtles for their meat and eggs as a nutritional source and for other economically important products. (Kapurusinghe and Cooray 2002; Eckert et al 1999). In Sri Lanka marine turtles have been exploited by humans for many centuries (de Silva 1996). It is reported that Sinhala kings sent ornamental scutes of Hawksbill (*Eretmochelys imbricate)* as gift items to overseas kings (de Silva 1996). This indicates that turtles have been in the commercial focus over the ages. At present Turtle populations in the country are endangered due to incidental by-catch of marine fisheries, direct exploitation of eggs and meat in various ways, coral mining, offshore construction and pollution. According to IUCN/SSC marine turtle specialist group (1999) increased commercialization of sea turtle products over the course of 20th century has decimated many turtle populations around the world and in Sri Lanka the populations are no longer economically viable or culturally significant (Kapurusinghe and Cooray 2002). [T1]

The IUCN Red Data Book enlists all five Sri Lankan species **as** endangered. All five are also included in CITIES Appendix I. According to IUCN 2000 Red List, The Letherback turtle (*Dermochelys coriacea*) and Hawksbill turtle (*Eretmochelys imbricata)* belong to the critically endangered category while the Loggerhead turtle(*Caretta caretta*) Green turtle (*Chelonia mydas*) and Olive Ridely turtle (*Lepidochelys olivacae)* belong to the endangered category.

Department of wildlife conservation of Sri Lanka (DWLC) has taken some measures to conserve country's marine turtles. Highlighted measures taken are the preparation of turtle action plan in 2005, signing of memorandum of understanding on the conservation and management of turtles and their habitats of the Indian Ocean and South –East Asia in 2005, and working hand in hand with NGO to establish hatcheries along the southern coastal line[T2] . However, Marine Turtle Specialist Group news letter in 2005 reports that the majority of these hatcheries are poorly managed and do not take real effort to re-create natural nesting conditions that would subsequently yield natural hatchling ratios. It is further mentioned that these poorly maintained hatcheries are further endangering local turtle populations. In Sri Lanka very little data is available from properly conducted scientific research on sea turtles and their habitats. As a consequence currently there is a data gap [T3] in our knowledge of marine turtle population dynamics, foraging and nesting habitat selection, life histories and threats. This hampers the conservation and recovery of marine turtles in Sri Lanka. Therefore, the Sri Lanka Wildlife Conservation society (SLWCS) recognizes the importance of carrying out scientific research on turtles to bring down the current population decline rate.

The need to conserve marine turtles is clear, however in Sri Lanka this has been compounded by 25 years civil conflict and the Tsunami of 2004. These additional features have led to a greater dependence, by the coastal community on biological resources i.e. supplementing incomes by trading in turtle eggs and resulted in weaker understanding and documentation of marine turtles in Sri Lanka compared to other parts of the world. Marine turtles are believed to nest extensively across Sri Lanka and having entered into a new period of stability and peace two areas have been identified where we wish to intensify efforts. These areas are the Kalpitiya-Karaitive-Puttalam coastal zone in the North-west and the Kumana-Pottuvil coastal zone in the South-east.

Project Locations

Our pilot surveys have helped us identify two critical sites on the Ampara and Kalpitiya coast lines. SLWCS intends to establish long term turtle conservation programmes in these two sites at Kalpitiya and Modarapalassa(Kirinda) , bearing following objectives.

Study Sites:

Kalpitiya

The Kalpitiya-Karaitive-Puttalam Coastal Wetlands Complex forms a part of the Puttalam Lagoon, which is the largest inland brackish to saline water body in Sri Lanka. The Puttalam Lagoon has been identified as a wetland of international importance in the Directory of Asian wetlands (Scott, 1989). It is a large, shallow lagoon situated along the west coast of Sri Lanka in the North Western province in the Puttalam District. The lagoon is separated from the ocean by a 45 km long, permanent sand bar, the Kalpitiya Peninsular, which opens up in its northern end to the Indian Ocean. The main habitat types comprises of estuaries and deltas, inter-tidal mud flats, sand flats, mangrove swamps, mangrove forests, marshes, sea-grass beds, beaches, scrubland and saltpans(SLWCS 2006). The climate in the area is that of the low country dry zone, having an annual rainfall of 1000-1250mm with average temperatures ranging between 30 0C (CEA 1994).

Two species namely Green Turtle (*Chelonia mydas*) and Olive Rridley (*Lepidochelys olivacea*) were recorded in coastal waters of Kalpitiya during the survey conducted by SLWCS in 2006. [T4] [T5] Several other observations on other species have also been made, and these are yet to be confirmed.

According to Kapurusinghe and Cooray (2002) turtle by-catch is very high in this area compared to the other parts of the country about 10-15 turtles get entangled in fishing nets daily. However SLWCS field surveys revealed that the daily numbers go up to about 50 or more during the fishing season. Fishermen slaughter these entangled turtles and this is common practice in the small islands in the Kalpitiya peninsula[T6] . Many of the carapaces of slaughtered turtles lying in the islands belong to Olive Rridley (*Lepidochelys olivacea*) turtles. Presence of large number of Olive Rridley (*Lepidochelys olivacea*) turtles in Kalpitiya waters is thought to be due to two factors. Firstly turtle migration. Migration from Orrisa in India is through kalpitiya where a large number of Olive Rridley (*Lepidochelys olivacea*) congregates to lay eggs. Secondly the rich sea grass beds and algae in the North Eastern coastal belt attract many a turtles from India (Kapurusinghe and Cooray 2002). There have however been no records of turtles nesting in the area up to date. During SLWCS field surveys we learned from the locals that they have come across turtle nests and crawling juveniles along some parts of the Kalpitiya coast[T7] .

Eastern district – Ampara to Trincomalee

It is intended to survey the entire coastline between Pottuvil and Trincomalee however initial surveys have highlighted Komari, Arugama, Panama and Okanda as sites of special interest. (Please provide me with an accurate description of this area)????

Modarapalassa is situated in Southern province of Sri Lanka. The 17Km stretch between Modarapalassa and Palatupana is mainly comprised of sandy beaches and mangrove. The beach on both sides is protected National Park land. This area is another important nesting ground for all five turtle species. Yet no one has monitored the nesting activities in the area. The turtle by-catch in the area is probably low due to the small scale of the fishing activities taking place in the area (Kapurusinghe and Cooray 2002).

This project aims to establish a permanent base of research for east coast conservation and the training and development of local conservationists. Key to this objective is the integration of education and capacity building activities such as computer and GIS training courses, which in turn will facilitate rapid and efficient analysis of data, the synthesis of reports and driven conservation strategies. Through this centre and its activities an assessment of the Eastern Provinces coastal zones flora and fauna shall be carried out, engaging the community and providing baseline data-sets with which to help assist in the future zoning of new developments, and key to identifying means of income diversification, vital for poverty reduction and encouraging the sustainable use of already degrading biodiversity.

The in-situ conservation program utilizing nest protection systems and activities described above will be used to develop community stewardship led management of the biological resources to install sustainable thinking practises and further underpin good management of any future Eco-tourism orientated activities.

1.2 Implementing strategy *(Details on what you will do, where, how and when)*

The implementing strategy involves

- ❍ Creating a fit between the way things are right now and what it takes to change it for the better.
- ❍ Executing strategy proficiently & efficiently
- ❍ Producing the expected results in a timely manner
- ❍ Most important FITS are between strategy AND
    - ❒ Target group capabilities
    - ❒ Reward structure
    - ❒ Internal and external support systems
    - ❒ Target group culture

The implementing strategy will be integrative taking into consideration the organizational structure of the WRDS' and the cultural and social background of the focus group.

1.3 Partners roles and the responsibilities

1.4 Sustainability

The core philosophy of sustainability is "development that meets the needs of the present without compromising the ability of future generations to meet their own needs." This concept of sustainability challenges public and private organizations as well as individuals to encompass ideas, aspirations and values to become better stewards of the environment and to promote positive economic growth and social objectives. The principles of sustainability can stimulate technological innovation, advance competitiveness, and improve peoples' quality of life.

Philosophy: To define the focus, goals and objectives of the target group and to ensure clarity in internal and external communications.
Policies: Establish a standardized policy to be implemented and audited across all operations of the focus group. This is essential to identify likely risks and procedures for mitigating them.
Programs: Select programs across key themes, which could effectively utilize our organizational expertise to maximize social and economic impact.
Partners: To expand the social and economic network by creating a larger canvas by combining our efforts with other industry leaders, markets, NGOs, development agencies, programs, and initiatives.

2. Targeted Beneficiaries

3. Overall Objective

4. Project purpose

5. Outcome and Methodology

Outcomes (Socio-economic):

Outcomes (Project):

Methodology (Socio-economic)

Community Needs Assessment using PRA and RRA methodologies. The tools used for Community Needs Assessment will be based on RRA & PRA methodologies;RRA: Rapid Socio-economic survey (interviews and Focus Group Discussions) PRA: Some of the tools used will be; Problem Tree, Wealth Ranking, Livelihood mapping, Resource mapping, Women's daily routine charts, Mobility Mapping Social Network Mapping, Venn diagram. The format and structure of the capacity building efforts will be based on the outcomes of the PRA and RRA exercises. The training programs and transfer of technology needs to be structured to suit the intellectual and educational levels of the target group. -Chandeep 1/21/09 3:13 PM

Methodology (Project)

6. Activities

7. Inputs

8. Risks and Assumptions

Political

Economic

Social

Technological

9. Monitoring and Evaluation

10. Indicators

11. Means of Verification

12. Overall Budget

13. Work Plant

14. Staff structure proposed for the Project

15. Logical framework

ANNEXURE: ORGANIZATIONAL PROFILE FORMAT

Vision / Mission / Outreach

Founded in 1995, the Society is highly committed to developing solutions to address , sustainable livelihood, land use, and poverty alleviation and environmental conservation since these issues are all inextricably linked. The mission of the SLWCS includes:

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🎬♟♟♟♟♟♟♟♟♟Protection of biodiversity in priority areas and the sustainable use of natural resources.
🎬♟♟♟♟♟♟♟♟♟Scientific and social research to develop practical development strategies at the grassroots level and to strengthen rural institutions to promote cooperative governance and community involvement in conservation, tourism, and land use.

- ●▪ Fostering partnerships between communities, funding agencies, private enterprises, industries, government institutions, and policy makers to develop a realistic model for sustainable development and biodiversity conservation. -zeenath khalid 1/20/09 11:25 AM

Legal Status (please attach copy of registration certificate)

A fully registered voluntary social service non-governmental organization with the Ministry of Social Welfare in Sri Lanka (No L-77702 of November 20, 2003). A fully incorporated non-profit, tax-exempt 501-3c organization in the U.S.A. (Federal Tax Identification Number: 22-3509091)

Contact Person: Chandeep Corea

Registered Office Address: 38 Auburn Side, Dehiwala, Sri Lanka

Telephone/Fax: 011 2714710

E-mail: info@slwcs.org, ravi@slwcs.org, chandeepc@slwcs.org

Address of other offices, if any:

Organizational Structure and Management

Profiles of key management and operational staff:

Ongoing Activities

1. **Saving Elephants by Helping People (SEHP):** a multi-faceted holistic approach to elephant conservation that combines human elephant conflict resolution, capacity building, economic development, alternative agriculture, field research and tourism. Initiated in 1997 and being recognized and principles followed by the Department of Wildlife Conservation and Mahaweli Authority

2. **Wetland Conservation Project (WCP):** to develop work plans to combine long term research with community based initiatives for wetland conservation. The SLWCS has conducted socio-economic and biodiversity baseline studies in three important and distinctly different wetlands in the country.

3. **GIS as a tool for conservation:** to further the knowledge and understanding of the dynamics of ecosystems and human dominated landscapes where wildlife survives to develop models for effective conservation planning at the local, regional, and national level. We are organizing training programs and symposiums for this.

4. **Outdoor Environmental Education and Publication Program**: an exciting interactive and experiential learning opportunity for children to study ecology, evolution, environment, sustainable development, and conservation in the field. We are also producing posters and books in all languages.

5. **Captive Elephant Breeding Project:** to establish a pilot breeding program for the privately owned captive elephants using natural and artificial insemination methods. The project is in partnership with the Faculty of Veterinary Medicine and Animal Sciences of the University of Peradeniya and the Millennium Elephant Foundation.

Systematic Surveys: baseline and project evaluation surveys in all parts of Sri Lanka to gather date on resource utilization, threat assessments and biodiversity

BUDGET/LFA/Workplan